



The Landlord's Schedule E Deduction Checklist

The write-offs landlords miss most, mapped to their exact IRS Schedule E line. Tick what applies, then keep the receipt behind it. A record protects the number.

☐ Advertising & listing fees	line 5	☐ Tenant screening & photos	line 5
☐ Mileage — or actual auto costs	line 6	☐ Parking & tolls	line 6
☐ Routine cleaning & lawn care	line 7	☐ Pest control	line 7
☐ HVAC service & gutters	line 7	☐ Leasing commissions & finder fees	line 8
☐ Landlord / liability insurance	line 9	☐ Tax prep & legal for the rental	line 10
☐ Property manager / co-host	line 11	☐ Mortgage interest (Form 1098)	line 12
☐ Other loan interest	line 13	☐ Repairs: leaks, locks, paint	line 14
☐ Supplies & small tools	line 15	☐ Property tax	line 16
☐ Licenses & permits	line 16	☐ Electric / gas / water / trash	line 17
☐ Internet you provide	line 17	☐ Depreciation of the building	line 18
☐ Appliances & furniture	line 18	☐ Improvements (depreciated)	line 18
☐ HOA / condo fees	line 19	☐ Bank & payment fees	line 19

Schedule E line numbers per the 2025 IRS instructions. Not tax advice — some items depend on your situation.



The two things that trip landlords up

1. Repair or improvement? (line 14 vs. line 18)

REPAIR — deduct now, line 14

Keeps it in ordinary working order:
fix a leak, replace a lock, patch
drywall, a coat of paint.

IMPROVEMENT — depreciate, line 18

Betters, restores, or adapts:
a new roof, an addition, a whole
new HVAC system.

When unsure, ask your preparer before you file — and be consistent year to year.

2. Your 2026 key dates

April 15, 2026	File your 2025 return (Form 1040 + Schedule E) · Q1 2026 estimated tax due
June 15, 2026	Q2 2026 estimated tax due
September 15, 2026	Q3 2026 estimated tax due
October 15, 2026	Extended filing deadline (if you filed Form 4868)
January 15, 2027	Q4 2026 estimated tax due

Estimated payments apply if you expect to owe \$1,000+ for the year. Confirm your situation with a tax pro.



This is one page. Get the whole system.

The Rental Property Record Book — 94 pages built backwards from Schedule E: rent roll, expense ledger, mileage, depreciation, and a year-end summary you copy straight onto your return.

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